

“The Wall of Me”

A Study on Strongholds

Lesson #1

In the beginning, God made us (male and female) as legal authority on earth ...until they allowed the devil to become the “prince of the power of the air” by being disobedient.

This put us into spiritual warfare...not as a power struggle of forces between “good and evil” but as a struggle against TURTH against LIES....Satan establishes his territory in the lies we believe.

There are two kingdoms:
The kingdom of darkness: LIES
The kingdom of Light: TRUTH

Here’s how this happens to us:

You can know something and not believe

The Memory: A FILING CABINET

The memory serves as a:

- **Storage bank**
- **Filing cabinet of sorts**

...Where past experiences and information are kept.

In combining the souls (mind, will & emotions) intellectual and emotional dimensions (right/left side of brain), it keeps track of what we:

- **See**
- **Hear**
- **Feel experience**
- **And on and on**

Some believe that everything that we’ve ever experienced is stored there....even though we can’t recall it....this is where information is that we call “on the tip of my tongue”.

CONSCIOUS:

The conscious mind is what processes cognitive activity...in other words...we're aware of what it's working on.

SUB CONSCIOUS:

The subconscious mind, however, is what acts involuntarily of the conscious. Even while we are asleep...it is churning away! Researchers estimate that the overwhelming majority – perhaps as much as 85 to 90% of what we take in our brains happens in our subconscious.

CRUCIAL: *MOST of the time we are being controlled....or at the very least, influenced by this aspect of the SOUL! THIS IS CRUCIAL FOR US TO UNDERSTAND**

Our subconscious mind **NEVER** stops working: it doesn't get tired or even rest...in sleep...our conscious shuts down and our subconscious takes over!

AMAZING CAPACITY:

This tireless part of the brain has an amazing capacity to observe and process.

It picks up every minute detail of what's happening around you:

- Every sound
- Color
- Feeling
- Reaction

In fact...it even takes what we are unaware of...such as:

- what our peripheral vision is capturing
- audible sounds our ears detect
- but our conscious mind doesn't process

THE ULTIMATE FILING CABINET!

According to one study/research: the brain has a processing capacity of *one hundred trillion* instructions per second!!!!!!!!!!!!!! Wow!

This doesn't mean that the brain is just a PACKRAT! God designed this complicated piece of our bodies to serve an invaluable purpose:

***What's housed in the subconscious (memory) shapes every facet of who you are.

What's stored there determines much of your:

- personality
- forms your habits (both good and bad)
- controls your actions AND reactions
- basically becomes your BELIEF CENTER!

In other words, the sum total of what's stored there works together to determine what you really believe!!!!!!!!!!

REPETITION:

God made us in such a way that after repetition our subconscious mind assumes control and does the job for us!

Remember learning to tie your shoe?

- Tie a starting knot
- Make two loops
- Turn loop over and under the other loop
- Pull tight

After "repetition" you quickly picked up "how to" tie your shoes...b/c your subconscious mind took over and does the job for us....the "how to" is "stored" in the s/c....and now we can literally tie our shoes in our sleep!

Other examples:

- **Writing**
- **Swinging a bat**
- **Brushing our teeth**
- **Learning to drive (especially a standard transmission)**

BUILDING A BELIEF/AND A STRONGHOLD:

The subconscious mind builds a belief by using:

- **Facts**
- **Processes**
- **Techniques**
- **Also uses perceptions**
- **Feelings**
- **Thoughts**
- **Initial senses**
- **Reactions**

A stronghold is a habit structure of thinking. Jack Frost

Determining Factors of Strongholds: There are Two factors that determine:

- A)whether what's stored in the subconscious becomes a belief (controlling memory) and**
- B)it's strength**

1ST FACTOR: Repetitious Information –

This refers to how often we

- **hear a certain fact**
- **perform a certain action**

- or experience a certain emotion.

The significance of repetitious information: how often we encounter it!

2nd FACTOR: Impactful Information

Some things need only to be experienced ONCE....or just a few times for them to become indelibly IMPRINTED on our soul!

Example:

Trauma of a rape

Loss of a parent/loved one

These need NOT be REPEATED for the memory to become controlling.

The significance of Impactful information: how we feel when we experience it!

A belief's strength is determined by a combination of repetition and intensity!

STRONGHOLDS:

When the images stored in our memory banks are strong enough and negative in nature (destructive, painful and so forth), a massive structure of negative belief is erected. The Bible calls this a STRONGHOLD.

2 Corinthians 10:4 (New International Version)

4The weapons we fight with are not the weapons of the world. On the contrary, they have divine power to demolish strongholds.

The Greek term *ochuroma* means “a castle, fortress, stronghold, a place from which to rule or hold onto something. This Greek word was also used as the word for PRISON.

Strongholds are, biblically speaking, inappropriate fortresses constructed in our mind from which we can be ruled or controlled.

They’re beliefs – conscious and subconscious – through which we’re so held captive that we can’t escape on our own!

STORY:

Man walking streets of Hong Kong

Noticed a tattoo studio

Window displayed samples of tattoo’s available

Flag, mermaids, hearts, etc.

One tattoo... “born to lose”

He entered shop...asked the manager if anyone ever had this phrase tattooed on his body?

He said, Yes.

He couldn’t understand that...

Manager tapped his forehead...said...in broken English...

“before tattoo on body...tattoo on mind!”

MIND TATTOO’S:

Strongholds are

NEGATIVE....DESTRUCTIVE....THOUGHT PATTERNS...

tattooed on the mind.

IF allowed to develop...they can imprison a person for life!

A stronghold is an unbiblical thinking pattern.

The way (the access points) the enemy gets in is through 4 ways:

1) Influence:

2) Oppression:

3) Possession:

4) Demonized: What happens in the spiritual realm is that we give over legal rights to demons to be allowed them to enter into our body and soul – they will be quick to move in. We open a door.

OPEN DOORS:

Specific Areas that Demons will Use to Come After a Person

1. Direct, Wilful Sin
2. The Occult (horoscope, tarot cards,
3. Inheritance – Generational (fear, anger, etc)
4. Un-forgiveness
5. Trauma
6. Abuse
7. Ungodly Soul Ties
8. Curses
9. Addictions
10. Fears and Phobias
11. False Religions
12. Cursed Objects (we need to cleanse our house of any statues, objects ... there are curses pronounced on some of those things before they are sent to market to sell...Holy Spirit will quicken to you what that is in your home).

13. Cursed Buildings (We pray over hotels we stay in...over these camps that we use...over homes we buy....over church buildings that we buy to start a church in....you never know what has happened in that place before you got there)

So...if Christ defeated Satan on the cross...and HE DID...this means that the devil remains illegally in the territory of God (US) until we exercise our authority and cast him out (dislodge him).

HOW:

Satan doesn't have to be directly involved in the forming of a stronghold. Our mind can do this very well on its own! As the father of lies...Satan's method is to use – DECEPTION.

He takes thoughts and feelings we receive into our subconscious, infuses the information w/his interpretation, and skillfully forms them into belief systems.

**Booster song: The devil is a sly old fox...
If I could catch him I'd put him in a box
Lock the door and throw away the key
For all those tricks he's played on me!**

1 Peter 5:7-9 (King James Version)

7Casting all your care upon him; for he careth for you.

8Be sober, be vigilant; because your adversary the devil, as a roaring lion, walketh about, seeking whom he may devour:

9Whom resist steadfast in the faith, knowing that the same afflictions are accomplished in your brethren that are in the world.

2 Corinthians 2:11

Lest Satan should get an advantage of us: for we are not ignorant of his devices.

One of the things that often makes his tactics so effective is that he uses real events and factual impressions.

EXAMPLES:

You REALLY were rejected by your father...when he left your family.

Your husband really did leave you...

You really were actually called ugly as a teenager

REMINDS US:

Satan...then reminds us again and again of these occurrences and distorts them w/his interpretations to the point that we accept his suggestions as truth. THEN...they become a part of our belief system!

DECADES AGO

**In this way....something that happened to us years...even...
DECADES AGO...is controlling us!**

What happens to us (the facts) is not really what creates the stronghold...but....what we believe about what happened to us is what creates a stronghold.

That's pretty heavy!

Proverbs 23:7 (New King James Version)

7 For as a man thinks in his heart, so is he.

Strongholds produce involuntary actions. What is believed in our subconscious mind is what we will ultimately act out!

- 1) whether or not we want to**
- 2) whether or not we realize – it’s “why” we are acting a certain way**
- 3) even if we’re not consciously aware – that the stronghold exists!**

BUMMER!

Ever heard someone say... “I don’t know why I do the things I do?”

The answer is hidden in the subconscious!

The subconscious has the real “SAY SO” in what we believe and how we act! We may consciously choose to believe something else, but until it is accepted and believed in our subconscious, our belief center, we will not permanently change!

EXAMPLES:

All your life you’ve struggled w/a negative self image... standing in front of the mirror and consciously choosing to believe something different contrary to your subconscious doesn’t bring lasting results.

Anger Issues: repeatedly telling yourself...I will NO LONGER yield to that rage...but then something touches that hidden place in your s/c...and sets you off again.

These things will ALWAYS be the same...UNTIL your subconscious – your belief center – is changed!

Someone once said... “Thinking is the talking of the soul with itself.”

What's believed in the subconscious doesn't have to be true to control us! It merely has to be believed!

HELP! WHAT CAN WE DO?

Jesus is the method, the ROAD that leads to TRUTH AND LIFE! He is the Way back to truth for our soul and life for our spirit.

James 1:21-22 (Amplified Bible)

21 So get rid of all uncleanness and the rampant outgrowth of wickedness, and in a humble (gentle, modest) spirit receive and welcome the Word which implanted and rooted [in your hearts] contains the power to save your souls. (NIV - which can save you. American Standard Version...which is able to save your souls.)

22 But be doers of the Word [obey the message], and not merely listeners to it, betraying yourselves [into deception by reasoning contrary to the Truth].

THIS IS A PROCESS! [Your Body will basically obey whatever your soul decides!]

Ephesians 4:23

And be constantly renewed in the spirit of your mind [having a fresh mental and spiritual attitude],

Colossians 3:10

And have clothed yourselves with the new [spiritual self], which is [ever in the process of being] renewed and remolded into [fuller and more perfect knowledge upon] knowledge after the image (the likeness) of Him Who created it.

Romans 12:2

Do not be conformed to this world (this age), [fashioned after and adapted to its external, superficial customs], but be transformed (changed) by the [entire] renewal of your mind [by its new ideals and its new attitude], so that you may prove [for yourselves] what is the good and acceptable and perfect will of God, even the thing which is good and acceptable and perfect [in His sight for you].

2 Corinthians 4:16 (Amplified Bible)

16Therefore we do not become discouraged (utterly spiritless, exhausted, and wearied out through fear). Though our outer man is [progressively] decaying and wasting away, yet our inner self is being [progressively] renewed day after day.

Philippians 3:10

[For my determined purpose is] that I may know Him [that I may progressively become more deeply and intimately acquainted with Him, perceiving and recognizing and understanding the wonders of His Person more strongly and more clearly], and that I may in that same way come to know the power outflowing from His resurrection [which it exerts over believers], and that I may so share His sufferings as to be continually **transformed** [in spirit into His likeness even] to His death, [in the hope]

2 BIG STICKS/WEAPONS! THE WORD and DECLARATIONS !

The Word of God is given several names in the Bible:

a. A hammer (Jeremiah 23:29) – to convict

29 "Is not my word like fire," declares the LORD, "and like a hammer that breaks a rock in pieces?"

b. A fire (Jeremiah 23:29) – to refine

c. A mirror (James 1:23) – reflect

- d. A seed (1 Peter 1:23, Matthew 4) – to multiply**
- e. A laver (Ephesians 5:26) – to cleanse**
- f. A lamp (Psalm 119:105) – to guide**
- g. A Sword (Hebrews 4:12) – to cut and defend.**

2 Corinthians 10:3-5 (Amplified Bible)

3For though we walk (live) in the flesh, we are not carrying on our warfare according to the flesh and using mere human weapons.

4For **the weapons of our warfare** are not physical [weapons of flesh and blood], but they are **mighty before God for the overthrow and destruction of strongholds,**

5[**Inasmuch (to the extent or degree that) as we** **refute arguments and theories and reasonings and every proud and lofty thing that sets itself up against the [true] knowledge of God;** and **we lead every thought and purpose away captive** into the obedience of Christ (the Messiah, the Anointed One),

DECLARATIONS

JOB 22:28

Dr. Caroline Leaf.

21 days detox of your mind.

Tell my story.

Over the next few weeks we are going to do just this w/the 16 different strongholds mentioned in scripture...

We are going to use the WORD & PRAYER to BREAK free of these mindsets...the “truths” that are really un-truths that have been established in our souls!

We will cover:

- 1. the Spirit of Divination – the practice of foretelling future events**
- 2. Familiar spirit – talking to the dead...yoga...psychic powers, mind-altering drugs**
- 3. Jealousy**
- 4. Lying spirit**
- 5. Perverse Spirit – homosexuality, incest, adultery...etc.**
- 6. Pride**
- 7. Spirit of Heaviness – sorrow/grief/hopelessness/self-pity/loneliness/insomnia/inner hurts & bruises**
- 8. Spirit of Whoredoms – fornication/idolatry/worldliness/excessive appetites/love of money/unfaithfulness-adultery/chronic dissatisfaction**
- 9. Spirit of Infirmary – bent body/arthritis/lingering disorders/cancer/weakness/asthma/allergies/oppression/impotence**
- 10. Deaf/Dumb spirit – Crying/ear problem.pining away/suicidal/seizures/epilepsy/mental illness/blindness**
- 11. Spirit of Bondage – fears/addictions/fear of death/compulsive sin/servant of corruption**
- 12. Spirit of Fear – phobias/heart attacks/torment/nightmares/fear of man/fear of death/untrusting/anxiety/stress**
- 13. Seducing Spirits – hypocritical lies/seared conscience/deception/fascination to evil ways, objects or persons/wander from truth/seducers**
- 14. Spirit of Anti-christ – denies deity of Christ/denies atonement/humanism/teachers of heresies/deceiver/anti-christ & his teachings/lawlessness/worldly speech & actions/**
- 15. Spirit of Error – unsubmitive/unteachable/defensive/argumentative/new**

**age movement/contentions/false doctrines/servant of
corruption**
16. Spirit of Death

FATHER OF LIES:

John 8:44 (New International Version)

44 You belong to your father, the devil, and you want to carry out your father's desire. He was a murderer from the beginning, not holding to the truth, for there is no truth in him. When he lies, he speaks his native language, for he is a liar and the father of lies.

